▼ GLASSHOUSE



DETENTION, WITH A SIDE OF CHAI

The BJP-led Assam government has really caught the 'detention' bug. After 'Bangladeshi miyas' and other '*ghuspaithiyas* (infiltrators)', next up are the state's MLAs. Cultural affairs minister Bimal Borah has proposed a 'detention room' at the state assembly to hold suspended MLAs, complete with tea service. This is so they don't end up briefing the media with 'misleading information' as soon as they are ejected. Speaker Biswajit Daimary says the secretariat will study the idea, floated after Raijor Dal's Akhil Gogoi was suspended (yet again). An apoplectic Gogoi called the proposal "unconstitutional", but Badruddin Ajmal's AIUDF said it like it is—the state treating elected representatives "the way it treats illegal immigrants", a reminder of Assam's long history of detention centres.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ TO S.I.R., WITH NO LOVE

VOTER VAGARIES

The Bengal BJP is learning the hard way that tightening the electoral screws will be no easy task in the volatile state. State chief **Samik Bhattacharya** recently snapped at CEC **Gyanesh Kumar**, warning that "wisdom from Delhi won't work" and urging him to camp in South 24 Parganas, Bardhaman and Diamond Harbour to see the SIR (Special Intensive Revision) chaos firsthand. Opposition leader in the assembly **Suvendu Adhikari**, meanwhile, has accused chief secretary Manoj Pant of nudging officials to be overly "generous", keeping more names on the rolls than the BJP would prefer. The quiet truth lies beneath the noise: the much-hyped SIR drive isn't producing the political math it had hoped for. An inside source says the pruned voter list may see the BJP's own vote bank shrinking.

